

THE BIG SKILLING ILLUSION

A DECADE AFTER ITS LAUNCH TO BRIDGE INDIA'S SKILLS GAP, THE PRADHAN MANTRI KAUSHAL VIKAS YOJANA IS UNDER SCRUTINY BY PARLIAMENTARY COMMITTEES AFTER A CAG REPORT FLAGGED SYSTEMIC LAPSES AND THE WIDE GAP BETWEEN TARGETS AND OUTCOMES

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In early June, Parliament's Public Accounts Committee (PAC), chaired by senior Congress leader K.C. Venugopal, turned the spotlight on the Narendra Modi government's flagship skilling programme, the Pradhan Mantri Kaushal Vikas Yojana (PMKVY). Drawing on a damning performance audit by the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG), the panel flagged serious shortcomings in the scheme's implementation, saying it had fallen well short of its stated objectives.

Introduced on July 15, 2015, PMKVY was designed to equip millions of young Indians with industry-relevant skills and formal certification, bridging the gap between education and employability. But the CAG audit report, tabled in Parliament in December 2025, cast a long shadow over the first three phases of the scheme